

Manners

Where Manners Matter

餐厅与聚会 — dinner or a party: who sits down first, who eats first

会议 — meetings: arrive on time and do not interrupt

博物馆 — museums: do not touch what is on display

公共交通 — public transport: give up your seat when it is needed

插队 — cut in line: go in front of people who waited

图书馆 — libraries: keep your voice down

家庭聚会 — family gatherings: greet the older relatives first

线上聊天 — group chats: know when not to send a message

电影院 — movie theaters: no phones and no talking

洗手间 — public restrooms: leave it clean for the next person

打电话 — phone calls: know when it is okay to call

Manners and Modern Life

面子 — face: the respect you have in front of others

繁文缛节 — empty formalities: old rules that no longer mean much

假客气 — fake politeness: acting polite without meaning it

死板 — stiff: following rules with no warmth

代沟 — generational gap: old and young with different habits

社交距离 — personal space: the space you keep around your body

隐私 — privacy: the right to keep things to yourself

Warm-up Discussion

What do you do to show politeness in everyday life?

Why do you think we have manners in the first place?

What are the table manners in your hometown?

What should you bring or say when you visit someone's home?

How much personal space do you need, and what do you do when someone stands too close?

Discussion

On a crowded subway after a long day at work, an older person gets on. What do you do, and what goes through your mind?

Someone's phone rings during a meeting. What do people around you usually do, and what do you do yourself?

In a movie theater, the person in front of you films the screen with their phone. What do you do, if anything?

You take a visiting friend out to dinner. Who pays, and how do you handle the bill without making it awkward?

You are ten minutes late for a meeting. What do you do — message first, call, or just walk in?

Traffic is heavy and another car wants to merge into your lane. Do you let it in, and what do most drivers in your city do?

Someone asks you for a favor in a group chat and tags your name. How fast do you have to reply to stay polite?

Which manners from the past have almost disappeared, and which new digital manners should exist?

Who should teach children manners — parents, school, or society — and who taught you?